

further strengthen the city's spiritual tourism ecosystem and create a more seamless pilgrimage experience. We also want visitors to experience what the region offers beyond the Kumbh, including its spiritual heritage, history, vineyards, and local culture, so that their visit extends beyond the religious occasion and contributes to the local economy.

How do you plan to leverage Maharashtra's UNESCO forts, heritage sites, and cruise tourism to create globally competitive tourism experiences?

Maharashtra's UNESCO forts and heritage sites are living chapters of our legacy, and we're focused on presenting them the right way by combining conservation with accessibility. That means better last-mile connectivity, upgraded visitor infrastructure, and trained local guides who bring these stories to life for travellers from India and abroad. Through the NAMO Tourism Centres and the NAMO Tour Guide Skilling Programme, we are strengthening visitor services while building a skilled local tourism workforce. At the same time, we're strengthening the global branding of Maharashtra's heritage and diversifying tourism experiences through cultural, spiritual, river, and cruise tourism. We're also expanding boating and cruise tourism along the Konkan coast, linking it with our heritage circuits. Initiatives like India's first underwater museum around INS Guldar in Sindhudurg add a new dimension to marine tourism.

The Vision aims to attract large-scale private investment in tourism. What policy incentives do you believe will be most effective in bringing global investors to Maharashtra?

Investors want a policy environment that's transparent, predictable, and responsive—and that's exactly what we're building through Maharashtra's Tourism Policy. We're simplifying approvals, making it easier to do business, and opening up opportunities across hospitality, wellness, MICE, cruise tourism, and eco-tourism, with a strong focus on Public-Private Partnerships (PPPs). To facilitate investments, we are developing a dedicated land bank for tourism projects, creating a curated portfolio of PPP opportunities across the State, and establishing dedicated investment outreach mechanisms to engage investors both within India and in key international markets. The Maharashtra Convention Bureau (MCB) is positioning the State as a premier destination for Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions (MICE), while targeted roadshows and investor engagement programmes will showcase Maharashtra's investment-ready tourism projects to domestic and global investors. Maharashtra already offers strong connectivity, a diverse tourism portfolio, and a robust market. What we want to provide now is the confidence, institutional support, and policy certainty that convert this potential into world-class tourism infrastructure, greater private investment, more employment opportunities, and sustained long-term growth.

